



BrightLearn
STUDENT RESOURCES

2026 EDITION · STUDENT GUIDE

Free **AI Tools** to Build Your **Portfolio**

A curated guide to the best free AI-powered platforms students can use right now to design, build, and publish a portfolio that stands out — no coding experience required.

15+

FREE AI TOOLS

4

CATEGORIES

\$0

TO GET STARTED



01

AI Website & App Builders

These tools turn your ideas into working websites or apps just by describing what you want. Perfect for spinning up a portfolio site in minutes — even if you've never written a line of code.

Lovable

TOP PICK

lovable.dev

Describe your portfolio in plain English and Lovable builds the full site for you — pages, styling, and interactions included. You can keep refining it through chat until it looks exactly right, then publish with one click.

Free tier

No coding

Full apps

One-click publish

v0 by Vercel

v0.app

A specialist in beautiful, modern UIs. Type a prompt like "a portfolio hero section with a project grid" and v0 generates polished React + Tailwind components you can copy, edit, and deploy.

Free tier

React / Tailwind

Designer-grade UI

Bolt.new

bolt.new

A full development environment in your browser, powered by AI. Bolt builds, runs, and previews your project live — great when you want a working prototype with backend logic, not just a static page.

Free tier

Full-stack

Runs in browser

Claude Artifacts

RECOMMENDED

claude.ai

Ask Claude to build a portfolio page or interactive component, and it appears live in the chat as an "Artifact" you can preview, tweak, and download. Excellent for single pages, landing sites, and creative projects.

Free tier

Live preview

Great for learning

02 AI Coding & Writing Helpers

Use these to write your portfolio's text, fix bugs, generate project descriptions, or learn new skills. They're like having a tutor, copywriter, and developer on call — for free.

Claude

BEST ALL-ROUNDERclaude.ai

Excellent for writing, coding, and brainstorming. Ask it to write your "About Me" section, summarize your projects, debug your code, or explain a concept you're stuck on. The free tier is generous for daily portfolio work.

Free tier

Writing

Code

Artifacts

ChatGPT

chatgpt.com

The classic AI assistant. Strong at writing, summarizing, and quick coding help.

Free

Writing

Google Gemini

gemini.google.com

Free with any Google account. Pairs nicely with Docs, Slides, and Drive for portfolio prep.

Free

Google integration

GitHub Copilot

FREE FOR STUDENTSgithub.com/education

An AI pair-programmer that suggests code as you type inside VS Code or your editor of choice. Verified students get it free through the GitHub Student Developer Pack — along with dozens of other free tools and credits.

Free with student verification

Code completion

VS Code

Cursor

cursor.com

An AI-first code editor based on VS Code. Free tier includes generous AI completions and chat-with-your-codebase features — perfect for building and polishing your portfolio projects.

Free tier

Editor

Chat with code



03

AI Design Tools

Make your portfolio visually stunning — logos, banners, project mockups, and full layouts — without needing a design degree.

Canva

canva.com

Generate logos, banners, resumes, and project covers with Canva's AI features (Magic Studio). Huge free template library too.

Free tier

Templates

Figma

figma.com

The industry standard for UI design. Free for students, with built-in AI features for generating layouts and content.

Free for students

UI/UX

Framer

framer.com

AI website builder with beautiful animations. Type a prompt and get a designer-quality portfolio site you can publish for free on a Framer subdomain.

Free plan

Designer-grade

Microsoft Designer

designer.microsoft.com

Free AI design tool for social posts, project thumbnails, and presentations — great for the "showcase" parts of your portfolio.

Free

Quick visuals

04

Free Hosting & Deployment

Once your portfolio is built, put it online with a real link you can share on your CV and LinkedIn. All three options below have generous free tiers.

Netlify

netlify.com

Drag-and-drop your site folder, or connect a GitHub repo, and Netlify gives you a live URL. Free SSL, custom domain support.

Free tier

Drag & drop

Vercel

vercel.com

The home of v0. Push code to GitHub and Vercel deploys it instantly with a free `.vercel.app` URL. Perfect for React, Next.js, and modern frameworks.

Free tier

Auto-deploy

GitHub Pages

pages.github.com

Host any static site directly from a GitHub repo for free. Doubles as a way to show recruiters your code *and* the live site.

Free

From GitHub

Cloudflare Pages

pages.cloudflare.com

Fast, free hosting on Cloudflare's global network. Unlimited bandwidth on the free tier — great for student projects.

Free tier

Unlimited bandwidth



05

The Student Portfolio Workflow

Don't try to use everything at once. Here's a realistic, beginner-friendly path from blank page to a live portfolio link you can share — using only free tools.

1

Plan & Write Your Content

Open Claude or ChatGPT and ask it to help you draft your "About Me," project descriptions, and skills section. Be specific about your audience (e.g. internship recruiters, university admissions).

→ [Claude](#) · [ChatGPT](#) · [Gemini](#)

2

Generate the Site

Use Lovable or v0 to describe the portfolio you want. Mention your style (minimal, bold, colorful), the sections you need, and any inspiration sites. Iterate by chat until it feels right.

→ [Lovable](#) · [v0](#) · [Bolt.new](#) · [Claude Artifacts](#)

3

Polish the Visuals

Generate a logo and project thumbnails in Canva or Microsoft Designer. Drop them into your site to make it feel personal and intentional, not template-y.

→ [Canva](#) · [Microsoft Designer](#) · [Figma](#)

4

Refine the Code

Open the generated code in Cursor or VS Code (with GitHub Copilot if you're a verified student). Ask the AI to fix small issues, add a contact form, or make it mobile-friendly.

→ [Cursor](#) · [GitHub Copilot](#) · [Claude](#)

5

Deploy & Share

Push your project to GitHub, then connect it to Netlify or Vercel for an instant live URL. Add the link to your CV, LinkedIn, and email signature.

→ [Netlify](#) · [Vercel](#) · [GitHub Pages](#) · [Cloudflare Pages](#)

★ BRIGHTLEARN TIPS FOR STANDING OUT

- Always include 2–3 real projects with screenshots and a short story of what you learned.
- Don't just list tools you used — show the result. Recruiters want to see outcomes.
- Ship small. A simple, working portfolio beats a perfect one that never goes live.
- Buy a custom domain (~\$10/year) once you're happy — it makes a huge first impression.
- Treat AI as a collaborator, not a ghostwriter. Edit everything in your own voice.



Now go build something **amazing.**

Your portfolio is the single best investment you can make in your future. Start small, ship it, and improve it every week. The tools are free — the only thing missing is you.

★ MADE WITH BRIGHTLEARN ★